

WEST ASIA, ENERGY SECURITY AND CONNECTIVITY

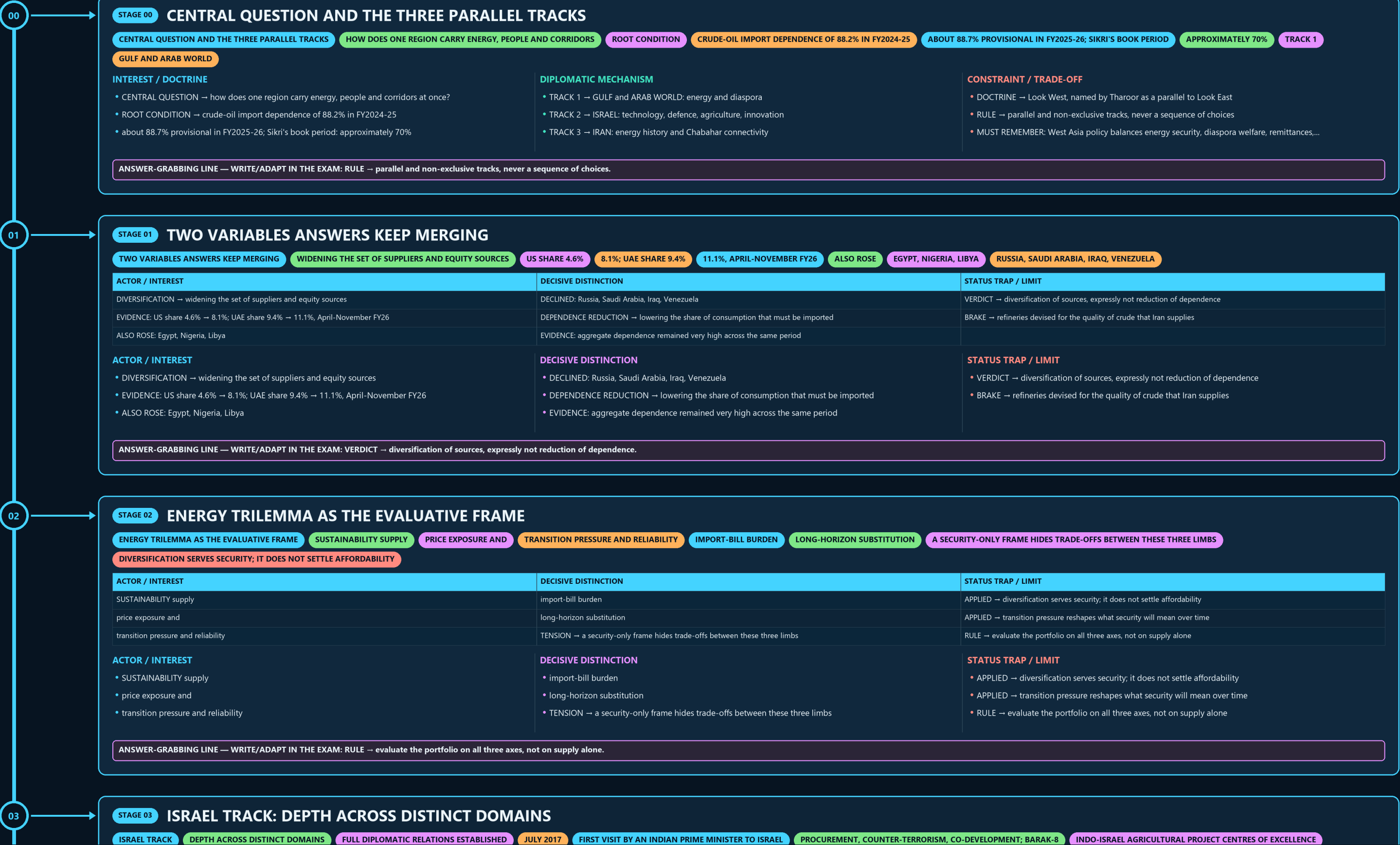
CENTRAL QUESTION AND THE → TWO VARIABLES ANSWERS KEEP → ENERGY TRILEMMA AS THE → ISRAEL TRACK: DEPTH ACROSS → GULF ARCHITECTURE WITH DATES → TRADE INSTRUMENTS AND THEIR

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



transition pressure and reliability

TENSION → a security-only frame hides trade-offs between these three limbs

RULE → evaluate the portfolio on all three axes, not on supply alone

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → evaluate the portfolio on all three axes, not on supply alone.

03

STAGE 03

ISRAEL TRACK: DEPTH ACROSS DISTINCT DOMAINS

ISRAEL TRACK

DEPTH ACROSS DISTINCT DOMAINS

FULL DIPLOMATIC RELATIONS ESTABLISHED

JULY 2017

FIRST VISIT BY AN INDIAN PRIME MINISTER TO ISRAEL

PROCUREMENT, COUNTER-TERRORISM, CO-DEVELOPMENT; BARAK-8

INDO-ISRAEL AGRICULTURAL PROJECT CENTRES OF EXCELLENCE

INDUSTRIAL R&D AND TECHNOLOGICAL INNOVATION FUND, 2017

1992 → full diplomatic relations established

JULY 2017 → first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel

DEFENCE: procurement, counter-terrorism, co-development; Barak-8

AGRICULTURE: Indo-Israel Agricultural Project Centres of Excellence

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

1992 → full diplomatic relations established

JULY 2017 → first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel

DEFENCE: procurement, counter-terrorism, co-development; Barak-8

AGRICULTURE: Indo-Israel Agricultural Project Centres of Excellence

INNOVATION: Industrial R&D and Technological Innovation Fund, 2017

MINILATERAL: I2U2 food, water, energy and technology cooperation

LIMITS → transfer depth, cost, extension and scaling, regional conflict

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMITS → transfer depth, cost, extension and scaling, regional conflict.

04

STAGE 04

GULF ARCHITECTURE WITH DATES AND FORUMS

GULF ARCHITECTURE WITH DATES AND FORUMS

9 SEPTEMBER 2024, RIYADH

INDIA-GCC JOINT ACTION PLAN 2024-2028, ADOPTED AT THE FIRST

22 APRIL 2025, JEDDAH

SECOND INDIA-SAUDI ARABIA STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP COUNCIL

18 FEBRUARY 2025

INDIA-QATAR AGREEMENT ON A BILATERAL STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP

25 JANUARY 2017

ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
9 SEPTEMBER 2024, RIYADH → India-GCC Joint Action Plan 2024-2028, adopted at the first Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue	18 FEBRUARY 2025 → India-Qatar Agreement on a Bilateral Strategic Partnership	RULE → name the dated instrument and its forum, never an undated partnership
22 APRIL 2025, JEDDAH → second India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council	25 JANUARY 2017 → India-UAE Comprehensive Strategic Partnership	9 SEPTEMBER 2024, RIYADH → India-GCC Joint Action Plan 2024-2028, adopted at the first Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue

ACTOR / INTEREST

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

9 SEPTEMBER 2024, RIYADH → India-GCC Joint Action Plan 2024-2028, adopted at the first Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue

22 APRIL 2025, JEDDAH → second India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council

18 FEBRUARY 2025 → India-Qatar Agreement on a Bilateral Strategic Partnership

25 JANUARY 2017 → India-UAE Comprehensive Strategic Partnership

RULE → name the dated instrument and its forum, never an undated partnership

9 SEPTEMBER 2024, RIYADH → India-GCC Joint Action Plan 2024-2028, adopted at the first Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → name the dated instrument and its forum, never an undated partnership.

05

STAGE 05

TRADE INSTRUMENTS AND THEIR FORCE STATUS

TRADE INSTRUMENTS AND THEIR FORCE STATUS

INDIA-UAE CEPA

IN FORCE SINCE 1 MAY 2022 REPORTED BILATERAL TRADE

INDIA-OMAN CEPA

SIGNED ON 18 DECEMBER 2025 ENTRY INTO FORCE REQUIRES

TARIFF AND TRADE-VOLUME MECHANICS BELONG TO THE ECONOMY OWNER

IR KEEPS

THE STRATEGIC-PARTNERSHIP SIGNIFICANCE OF EACH INSTRUMENT

ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
INDIA-UAE CEPA → IN FORCE since 1 May 2022 reported bilateral trade approximately USD 100 billion in FY2024-25	BOUNDARY → tariff and trade-volume mechanics belong to the Economy owner	INDIA-UAE CEPA → IN FORCE since 1 May 2022 reported bilateral trade approximately USD 100 billion in FY2024-25
INDIA-OMAN CEPA → SIGNED on 18 December 2025 entry into force requires separate verification	IR KEEPS → the strategic-partnership significance of each instrument	INDIA-OMAN CEPA → SIGNED on 18 December 2025 entry into force requires separate verification

ACTOR / INTEREST

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

INDIA-UAE CEPA → IN FORCE since 1 May 2022 reported bilateral trade approximately USD 100 billion in FY2024-25

INDIA-OMAN CEPA → SIGNED on 18 December 2025 entry into force requires separate verification

BOUNDARY → tariff and trade-volume mechanics belong to the Economy owner

IR KEEPS → the strategic-partnership significance of each instrument

INDIA-UAE CEPA → IN FORCE since 1 May 2022 reported bilateral trade approximately USD 100 billion in FY2024-25

INDIA-OMAN CEPA → SIGNED on 18 December 2025 entry into force requires separate verification

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: IR KEEPS → the strategic-partnership significance of each instrument.

06

STAGE 06

CORRIDOR DIPLOMACY AGAINST CORRIDOR INFRASTRUCTURE

CORRIDOR DIPLOMACY AGAINST CORRIDOR INFRASTRUCTURE

9 SEPTEMBER 2023, NEW DELHI

MEMORANDUM SIGNED BY EIGHT PARTIES

INDIA, U.S., SAUDI ARABIA, U.A.E., FRANCE, GERMANY, ITALY

11 JUNE 2024

MEMORANDUM READOUT REFERS TO COMMENCEMENT OF WORK

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06

INDIA-OMAN CEPA → SIGNED on 18 December 2025 entry into force requires separate verification

IR KEEPS → the strategic-partnership significance of each instrument

INDIA-OMAN CEPA → SIGNED on 18 December 2025 entry into force requires separate verification

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: IR KEEPS → the strategic-partnership significance of each instrument.

STAGE 06CORRIDOR DIPLOMACY AGAINST CORRIDOR INFRASTRUCTURE

CORRIDOR DIPLOMACY AGAINST CORRIDOR INFRASTRUCTURE9 SEPTEMBER 2023, NEW DELHIIMEC MEMORANDUM SIGNED BY EIGHT PARTIESINDIA, US, SAUDI ARABIA, UAE, EU, FRANCE, GERMANY, ITALY24 JUNE 2024MEA INDIA-UAE READOUT REFERS TO COMMENCEMENT OF WORK

NO COMPLETED CONSTRUCTION OR OPERATING SEGMENT OFFICIALLY ESTABLISHEDCONNECTIVITY DIPLOMACY CREATES MOMENTUM, NOT DELIVERED INFRASTRUCTURE

9 SEPTEMBER 2023, NEW DELHI → IMEC memorandum signed by eight parties

India, US, Saudi Arabia, UAE, EU, France, Germany, Italy

24 JUNE 2024: MEA India-UAE readout refers to commencement of work

STATUS: no completed construction or operating segment officially established

CONSEQUENCE → connectivity diplomacy creates momentum, not delivered infrastructure

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

• 9 SEPTEMBER 2023, NEW DELHI → IMEC memorandum signed by eight parties

• India, US, Saudi Arabia, UAE, EU, France, Germany, Italy

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

• 24 JUNE 2024: MEA India-UAE readout refers to commencement of work

• STATUS: no completed construction or operating segment officially established

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

• CONSEQUENCE → connectivity diplomacy creates momentum, not delivered infrastructure

• STRESS TEST → regional conflict raises political, security and route-risk costs

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: STRESS TEST → regional conflict raises political, security and route-risk costs.

STAGE 07IRAN TRACK: INSTRUMENT, WITHDRAWAL AND DISPUTED STATUS

IRAN TRACKINSTRUMENT, WITHDRAWAL AND DISPUTED STATUS14 JULY 2015JOINT COMPREHENSIVE PLAN OF ACTION CONCLUDED, IRAN WITH E3/EU+3ENDORSED BY UN SECURITY COUNCIL RESOLUTION 22318 MAY 2018UNITED STATES ANNOUNCES WITHDRAWAL; SANCTIONS RESTORED IN STAGESMAY 2019

14 JULY 2015 → Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action concluded, Iran with E3/EU+3

endorsed by UN Security Council resolution 2231

8 MAY 2018 → United States announces withdrawal; sanctions restored in stages

MAY 2019 → Significant Reduction Exceptions end; India ceases Iranian crude purchases

13 MAY 2024 → ten-year Chabahar contract signed

DATED OFFICIAL INSTRUMENT

• 14 JULY 2015 → Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action concluded, Iran with E3/EU+3

• endorsed by UN Security Council resolution 2231

• 8 MAY 2018 → United States announces withdrawal; sanctions restored in stages

EVIDENTIARY LEVEL IT REACHES

• MAY 2019 → Significant Reduction Exceptions end; India ceases Iranian crude purchases

• 13 MAY 2024 → ten-year Chabahar contract signed

• 29 SEPTEMBER 2025 → the 2018 Chabahar exception revoked with effect from this date

STATUS / CLAIM LIMIT

• 2025 → after the E3 snapback action the status of restored UN measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China

• do not call the Plan normally functioning

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 2025 → after the E3 snapback action the status of restored UN measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; do not call the Plan normally functioning.

STAGE 08COMPOUNDING RISK AT ONE CHOKEPOINT

COMPOUNDING RISK AT ONE CHOKEPOINTSTRAIT OF HORMUZNARROW OUTLET FROM THE PERSIAN GULF TO THE GULF FREIGHT, INSURANCE AND SUPPLY INSECURITY TRANSMIT IMMEDIATELYPHYSICAL SAFETY OF A VERY LARGE EXPATRIATE POPULATION IS

CORRIDOR AND PROJECT VIABILITY IS EXPOSED AT THE SAME DIVERSIFICATION DOES NOT REMOVE COMMON-ROUTE EXPOSURERESERVES AND ALTERNATIVE ENERGY REDUCE BUT DO NOT REMOVE

STRAIT OF HORMUZ → narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman

ENERGY: freight, insurance and supply insecurity transmit immediately

DIASPORA: physical safety of a very large expatriate population is exposed

CONNECTIVITY: corridor and project viability is exposed at the same moment

LIMIT → diversification does not remove common-route exposure

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

• STRAIT OF HORMUZ → narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman

• ENERGY: freight, insurance and supply insecurity transmit immediately

• DIASPORA: physical safety of a very large expatriate population is exposed

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

• CONNECTIVITY: corridor and project viability is exposed at the same moment

• LIMIT → diversification does not remove common-route exposure

• LIMIT → reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

• DISTINCTIVE → compounding rather than isolated risk, unlike most partner regions

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DISTINCTIVE → compounding rather than isolated risk, unlike most partner regions.

STAGE 09DIASPORA EXPOSURE PRICED WITH DATED EVIDENCE

DIASPORA EXPOSURE PRICED WITH DATED EVIDENCEA DIASPORA OF 5 MILLION IN THE GULF, PERIOD-SPECIFICTHE ARAB WORLD IS HOME TO NEARLY 6 MILLIONMEA TABLE, JANUARY 2026UAE 4,344,008SAUDI ARABIA 2,750,551POPULATION-STOCK ESTIMATES, NOT CITIZENSHIP OR OCI COUNTS27 JUNE 2025

ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
SIKRI → a diaspora of 5 million in the Gulf, period-specific	Saudi Arabia 2,750,551	3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel
THAROOR → the Arab world is home to nearly 6 million Indians, period-specific	STATUS → population-stock estimates, not citizenship or OCI counts	BOUNDARY → relief logistics to Disaster Management; consular diplomacy here and topic 09

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STAGE 09 DIASPORA EXPOSURE PRICED WITH DATED EVIDENCE

DIASPORA EXPOSURE PRICED WITH DATED EVIDENCE A DIASPORA OF 5 MILLION IN THE GULF, PERIOD-SPECIFIC THE ARAB WORLD IS HOME TO NEARLY 6 MILLION MEA TABLE, JANUARY 2026 UAE 4,344,008 SAUDI ARABIA 2,750,551 POPULATION-STOCK ESTIMATES, NOT CITIZENSHIP OR OCI COUNTS

27 JUNE 2025

ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
SIKRI → a diaspora of 5 million in the Gulf, period-specific	Saudi Arabia 2,750,551	3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel
THAROOR → the Arab world is home to nearly 6 million Indians, period-specific	STATUS → population-stock estimates, not citizenship or OCI counts	BOUNDARY → relief logistics to Disaster Management; consular diplomacy here and topic 09
MEA TABLE, JANUARY 2026 → UAE 4,344,008	27 JUNE 2025 → Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 nationals	CLOSE DISTINCTION: Political declaration, memorandum, treaty, investment pledge, corridor...

ACTOR / INTEREST • SIKRI → a diaspora of 5 million in the Gulf, period-specific • THAROOR → the Arab world is home to nearly 6 million Indians, period-specific • MEA TABLE, JANUARY 2026 → UAE 4,344,008	DECISIVE DISTINCTION • Saudi Arabia 2,750,551 • STATUS → population-stock estimates, not citizenship or OCI counts • 27 JUNE 2025 → Operation Sindhu evacuated 4,415 nationals	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT • 3,597 from Iran and 818 from Israel • BOUNDARY → relief logistics to Disaster Management; consular diplomacy here and topic 09 • CLOSE DISTINCTION: Political declaration, memorandum, treaty, investment pledge, corridor...
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Political declaration, memorandum, treaty, investment pledge, corridor.

10

STAGE 10 BALANCING WITHOUT CONTRADICTION

BALANCING WITHOUT CONTRADICTION DEEPENING ISRAEL TIES COULD BE READ AS A SLIGHT INDIA VALUES ISRAEL TIES BUT NOT AT THE EXPENSE A TWO-STATE POSITION COULD BE READ AS ABANDONING ISRAEL RECOGNITION OF THE STATE OF PALESTINE IN 1988 RUNS

THE OCTOBER 2023 CONFLICT TESTS BOTH LIMBS AT ONCE CONDEMN TERRORISM, SEEK HUMANITARIAN PROTECTION, HOSTAGE RELEASE, DIALOGUE ACTIVE BALANCING SUSTAINED BY CONTINUOUS EFFORT, NOT A SINGLE

INTEREST / DOCTRINE	DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM	CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF
• PROBLEM → deepening Israel ties could be read as a slight by Arab partners • RESPONSE: India values Israel ties but not at the expense of Arab and Muslim friendships • PROBLEM → a two-state position could be read as abandoning Israel cooperation	• RESPONSE: recognition of the State of Palestine in 1988 runs alongside full relations • PROBLEM → the October 2023 conflict tests both limbs at once • RESPONSE: condemn terrorism, seek humanitarian protection, hostage release, dialogue	• VERDICT → active balancing sustained by continuous effort, not a single declaration • EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Use named evidence with ministry,...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → active balancing sustained by continuous effort, not a single declaration.

11

STAGE 11 ANSWER SPINE FOR A WEST ASIA DEMAND

ANSWER SPINE FOR A WEST ASIA DEMAND STATE THE DEPENDENCE BASELINE WITH ITS EXACT FINANCIAL YEAR ENERGY, DIASPORA, TECHNOLOGY AND CONNECTIVITY, EACH WITH ONE DATED PRICE CHOKEPOINT EXPOSURE, SANCTIONS TRANSMISSION AND UNVERIFIED MINILATERAL ACTIVITY

GIVE A TRILEMMA VERDICT ON A NON-EXCLUSIVE PORTFOLIO, PREDICTING



INTEREST / DOCTRINE • OPEN → state the dependence baseline with its exact financial year and basis • BUILD → energy, diaspora, technology and connectivity, each with one dated instrument	DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM • TEST → price chokepoint exposure, sanctions transmission and unverified minilateral activity • CLOSE → give a trilemma verdict on a non-exclusive portfolio, predicting no price or outcome	CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF • OPEN → state the dependence baseline with its exact financial year and basis • BUILD → energy, diaspora, technology and connectivity, each with one dated instrument
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → give a trilemma verdict on a non-exclusive portfolio, predicting no price or outcome.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT INDIA-GCC JOINT ACTION PLAN (2024-2028) ADOPTED AT THE FIRST INDIA-GCC BILATERAL STRATEGIC ARCHITECTURE THE INDIA-SAUDI STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP UAE-INDIA CEPA (IN FORCE 1 MAY 2022) A BILATERAL TRADE-AGREEMENT I2U2 (INDIA-ISRAEL-UAE-US)

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE AND INSTRUMENT DEPTH • India-GCC Joint Action Plan (2024-2028): adopted at the first India-GCC • Bilateral strategic architecture: the India-Saudi Strategic Partnership • CAUTION: UAE-India CEPA (in force 1 May 2022): a bilateral trade-agreement • CAUTION: I2U2 (India-Israel-UAE-US): a minilateral framework on food security,	STATUS, DATE AND FIGURE LIMIT • IMEC/IMEEC: an eight-party MoU signed on 9 September 2023 (India, US, • Chabahar port (Iran): 10-year contract signed 13 May 2024; US sanctions • Direct PYQ boundary case (2025 Q19): the question's framing — energy • CAUTION: Boundary case — Iran under sanctions pressure: Tharoor notes "Iran's	COMPARATIVE DIPLOMATIC NUANCE • CAUTION: Boundary case — Israel-Palestine escalation risk: any escalation • CAUTION: Boundary case — diaspora welfare during regional conflict: any Gulf/ • CAUTION: Diversification manages risk but does not eliminate dependence: equity • CAUTION: Triangular balancing requires continuous diplomatic management: the
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OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.